GROWTH PLAN · WORKING SOURCE OF TRUTH · JULY 2026

Sweet Pointe Candy — The Growth Plan

One plan, sequenced. Each phase installs a small system that pays for itself before the next unlocks. The goal is a business that keeps generating when you're not in the room — not a calendar full of tasks.

You don't run a candy store. You run a destination.

People will drive 35–50 minutes for a place worth the trip. That changes who you compete with — a family's Saturday and a gift-buyer's click — and it moves the money off the shelf and into gifting, experiences, and the neighborhood. Candy is the traffic driver; the profit pools are curated boxes, parties, corporate gifting, and the email list you own.

> **The core tension: none of the big ideas are wrong. They're mis-sequenced.** The right question for a young shop isn't "what could we build?" — it's "what produces revenue this quarter?" So we treat each revenue stream as a feature we ship only after the last one works. That discipline is the whole plan.

The Spine — Four Phases, Each Unlocks the Next

- **Phase 0 — Get found.** GBP, schema, tracking, email capture. Pure plumbing, highest ROI in the plan.
- **Phase 1 — Local revenue.** Parties, three boxes, and corporate/realtor gifting — pulled forward.
- **Phase 2 — Content + retention.** Teen-led content, email flows, seasonal rhythm — only once Phase 1 produces.
- **Phase 3 — Expansion.** Shipping ecommerce, subscriptions, paid — once local is proven.

Revenue Priority Stack (Build In This Order)

Ranked by margin, speed to cash, and how little a small team has to lift — not by how loud the channel is.

1. **Corporate & realtor gifting.** Highest ticket, recurring, and locally uncontested. In Grosse Pointe, a realtor's closing-gift program can run $125–1,000+ per gift. Direct outreach, ten emails a week — one repeat account outweighs a month of walk-ins. **This is why it's pulled into Phase 1.**
2. **Gift buyers, year-round.** High-margin ready-to-gift boxes for every occasion. Lead with the occasion, not the ingredient list.
3. **Families: parties + experiences.** Bookable, plan-ahead revenue; the hands-on moments generate the photos families post for free.
4. **Teens & young adults.** The loudest room and the lowest-revenue one — they bring traffic and free content, not a P&L line. Fuel, not focus.

The Phased Roadmap

Phase 0 — Foundation

Weeks 1–2 · get found

Capture the demand that already exists. Nothing here is creative; it's plumbing — and it's the single highest-ROI work in the plan.

- Google Business Profile fully completed — categories (Candy Store *and* Event Venue), photos, products, booking link. This wins "candy near me."
- LocalBusiness/CandyStore schema on the site — how you get surfaced in Google and AI answers.
- Fix the placeholder social links; claim consistent handles. Email capture live in-store and on-site.
- Two hero paths on the homepage: **Book a Party** and **Shop Candy Boxes**. Everything else is secondary.

Phase 1 — Local Revenue

Weeks 3–8 · turn found into money

Two channels only — Google and Facebook — plus direct outreach for gifting. Gifting leads because it's the fastest, highest-margin cash.

- **Corporate & realtor gifting one-pager** + a 20-name outreach starter (local realtors, offices, schools). Ten warm emails a week.
- A dedicated **parties page** with packages, photos, and a booking link; promote in local parent groups.
- **Three curated boxes** launched — Movie Night, Birthday, Michigan Favorites — grab-and-go in store and orderable locally.
- Facebook as the community hub: 2–3 posts/week, mirrored to Instagram. No daily-content treadmill.

Phase 2 — Content & Retention

Weeks 9–16 · bring them back

Add the repeatable rhythm and the systems that bring people back — only after Phase 1 is producing.

- Teen-led content, lightweight: one weekly batch-film session → a handful of Shorts/Reels. Authentic beats polished. (Run with the minor-labor + FTC guardrails — see note.)
- Email automations: welcome series, birthday club, abandoned cart. Set once, runs forever.
- Seasonal pushes on the calendar that already drives candy demand: Halloween, Valentine's, Christmas, graduation, back-to-school.

Phase 3 — Expansion

Months 5+ · only once local runs itself

Turn proven boxes into shippable products; add a subscription only if a repeat-buyer list is already asking; start paid media once there's organic traffic and conversion data to retarget against.

Guardrail on teen content: all filming on-clock and within Michigan minor work-hour limits; signed parental consent for anyone under 18; FTC employment disclosure in the first seconds; a short written prohibited list. This is a real compliance layer, not a casual "have the kids post."

The Three Boxes (Launch These, Not Eight)

Box	Best audience	Price	Why it works
Movie Night	Families, couples	$24–36	Theater candy + popcorn + novelty soda. Repeatedly reinforced on gift/idea surfaces; raises AOV naturally.
Birthday in a Box	Parents, families	$35–60	Favors, candles, custom mix, mini add-on. Parents buy convenience; feeds the parties lane.
Michigan Favorites	Gift buyers, tourists	$28–40	Regional nostalgia + a store-exclusive mix. Something the national chains structurally can't replicate.

More SKUs = more inventory, photography, and buyer decision-fatigue. Prove these three, then add seasonal editions before everyday SKUs. Subscription comes last.

The Underpriced Lane: Corporate & Realtor Gifting

Almost no one local is competing for it, and the audience is full of the exact roles that buy it — realtors, office managers, HR, event planners. It's high-ticket, repeat, and low-content-effort.

- **The offer:** one page — "Corporate & Client Gifting: custom candy boxes, your logo, delivered locally" — with an inquiry form and a phone number.
- **The motion:** direct outreach, not ads. Ten warm emails or drop-ins a week. Realtor closing-gift boxes are recurring and brandable.
- **Keep a sub-$100 tier** — many corporate buyers have a ~$100 per-gift deductibility cap; don't price out the repeat, transactional buyer.

The Only Four Numbers That Matter (Until Phase 3)

Track this	Because
Party bookings	Plan-ahead revenue and the clearest sign the site is converting.
Box orders	The gift engine; shows which occasions and boxes actually sell.
Gifting inquiries	The highest-value lane; one account can outweigh a month of walk-ins.
Email signups	The one audience you own — the compounding asset.

A new shop doesn't need a thirty-metric dashboard. These four, and nothing else, until local revenue is proven. Vanity metrics — impressions, likes, follower counts — are exactly what "reports instead of customers" looks like. We don't report on them.

What To Cut Or Defer (For Now)

National shipping and a broad catalog → Phase 3, after boxes prove out. Subscription boxes → only after a repeat-buyer list asks. DoorDash/Uber Eats → their margins hurt a candy store; test in-store boxes and demand first. Paid advertising → wait for organic traffic and conversion data. Eight boxes, 100 keywords, 160 content ideas → start with three boxes, ~ten keywords, one weekly content batch.